



[BIT703 Web Technologies](#) / [Contents](#) / Topic 7: Client-side web application development and programming – JavaScript / Understanding JavaScript

# JavaScript functions 4m

Functions are one of the fundamental concepts in programming. They let us write concise, modular, reusable and maintainable code. This helps programmers and web developers to follow the DRY principle: Don't Repeat Yourself.

## What is a function in JavaScript?

A function is a block of reusable code written to perform a specific task; these tasks can be a small part of the main program but in isolation from the rest. A function consists of a set of statements that are executed as a single unit. They allow us to reuse code instead of rewriting it. In JavaScript, functions are also first-class objects, meaning they can be treated like variables.

For example, we may want to find the average grade on a test or assignment. If we have a list of grades, we can calculate an average. There is no need to write a separate set of coding to calculate an average if we're using a function, assuming we have a function that calculates the average and is available for us to use.

Watch *JavaScript Functions are Easy!* (Bro Code, 2023) (12:13), which serves as an instructional guide on understanding and implementing functions in JavaScript.



ENTER FULLSCREEN

Skip to main content

## JavaScript FUNCTIONS are easy!

**JavaScript FUNCTIONS are easy!**

Bro Code



Watch on

Search...



Hey, welcome back. So today I got to explain functions in JavaScript.

A function is a section of reusable code. You declare that code once and you can use it whenever you want. All you have to do is call the function to execute that code. Here's an example.

We'll create a function to sing Happy Birthday. Whenever we call this function, it's going to sing Happy Birthday. So to declare a function, you type function, a unique function name. Let's name our function happyBirthday because it's, well, the Happy Birthday function.

Then you add a set of parentheses. Then you add a set of curly braces. Any code we write between this set of curly braces, we can reuse whenever we want. So what do we

Powered by 3PLAYMEDIA

[Skip to main content](#)

## Function declaration in JavaScript

A JavaScript function consists of:

- the 'function' keyword
- the name of the function
- parentheses ( ), which can take in arguments or may also be empty
- the body of the function (wrapped in curly braces { }).

To create a function, declare it in the manner shown below – this is a simple function declaration.

```
<script>

function calc_product (a, b)

{

return a*b

}

</script>
```

This function takes the two parameters passed, multiplies them together and returns the product.



### Dig deeper

If you want to learn more about JavaScript functions, read these resources, which explain functions and demonstrate with examples:

Skip to main content

- [JavaScript Functions](#) (W3Schools, n.d.)

A large portion of your JavaScript writing will be done with functions, and it is recommended to read the page below on writing JavaScript functions.

► *Functions* (MDN, n.d.)



---

Thoughts on this page?

